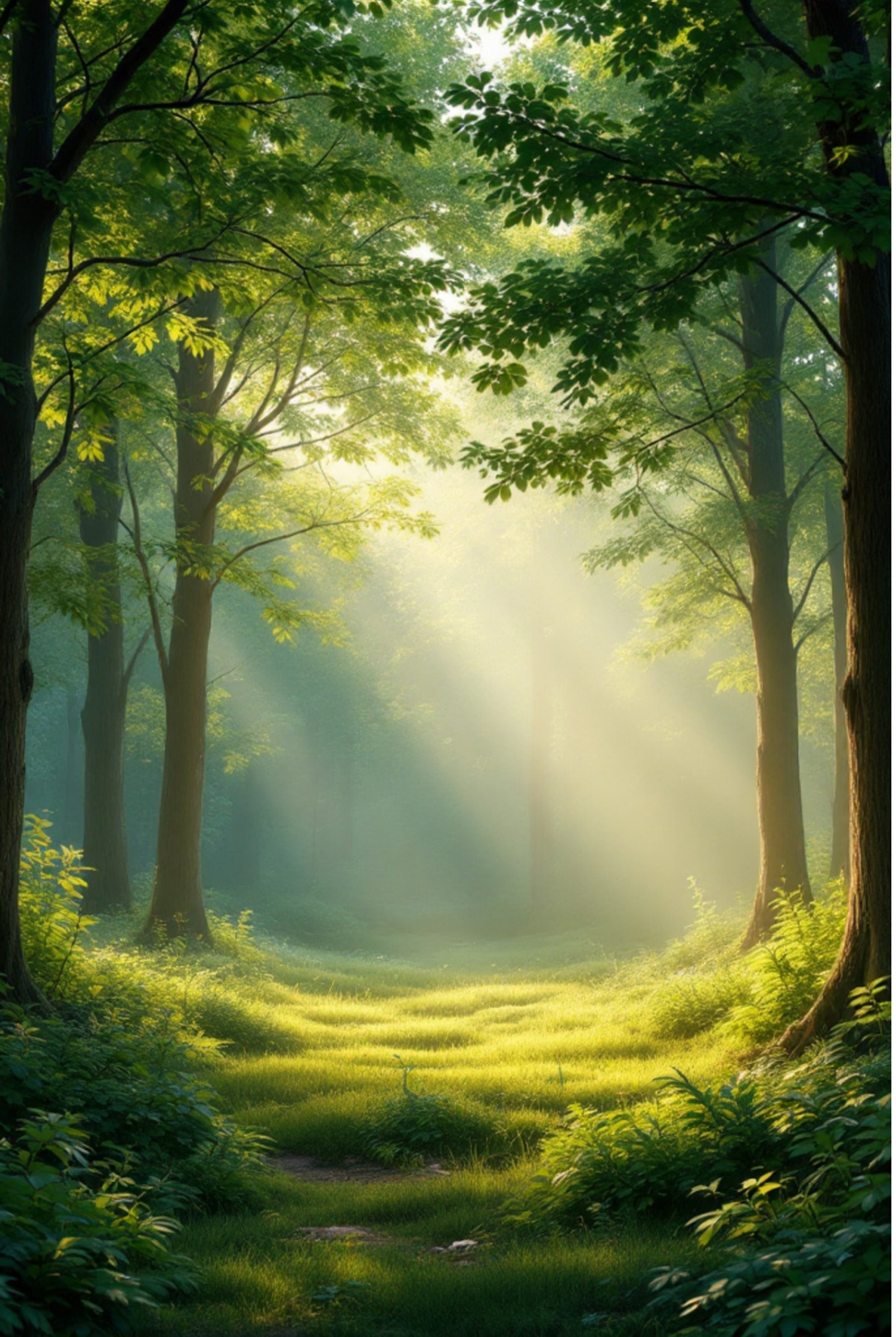


Trauma Recovery: Understanding Your Brain's Protective Response

An 8-lesson psychoeducation course on trauma, PTSD, grounding skills, and preparing for healing

What Happened *TO* You, Not What's Wrong *WITH* You

Trauma responses are not weaknesses or character flaws. They are your nervous system's survival mechanisms doing exactly what they were designed to do.

Hypervigilance

Constantly scanning for danger — your brain learned to stay alert to protect you.

Flashbacks

Intrusive memories are your mind trying to process and make sense of what happened.

Emotional Numbness

Shutting down feelings is a protective buffer against overwhelming pain.

Difficulty Sleeping

A nervous system on high alert struggles to feel safe enough to fully rest.

> The symptoms that feel like they're working **against** you are actually evidence that your brain is trying to **keep you safe**.

How Trauma Changes the Brain

Three key regions are profoundly affected by traumatic experience — understanding them helps explain why recovery can feel so difficult.

Amygdala

The Alarm System

Becomes hyperactive, firing threat responses even at non-threatening stimuli. It can no longer easily distinguish between past danger and present safety.

Hippocampus

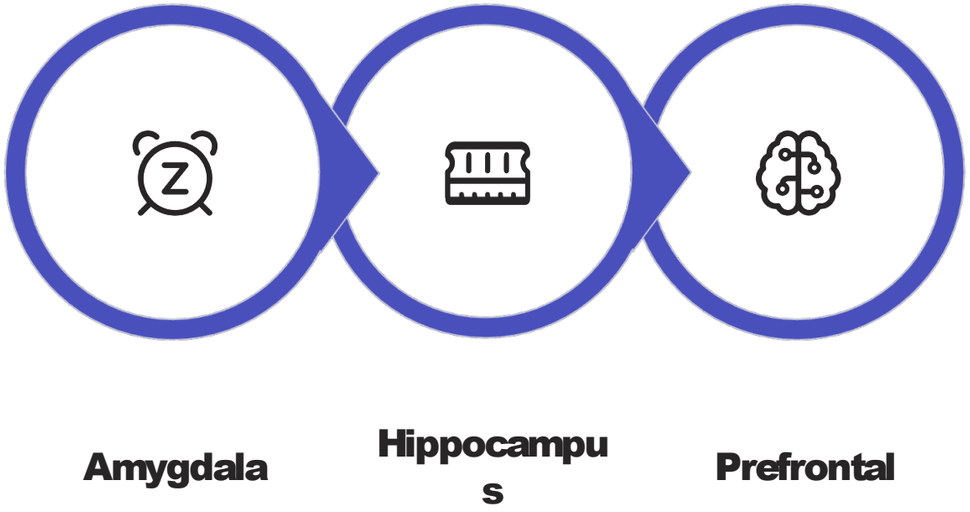
The Memory Organizer

Struggles to file traumatic memories properly, leaving them feeling vivid and "present" rather than safely stored in the past.

Prefrontal Cortex

Rational Thinking

Goes partially offline during activation, making it hard to think clearly, make decisions, or calm yourself down when triggered.



Understanding this cycle is the first step toward interrupting it — and that is exactly what this course is designed to help you do.

What You'll Learn

This course covers eight carefully sequenced topics, each building on the last to give you a complete foundation for healing.

01

Understanding Trauma & PTSD

What trauma is, how PTSD develops, and why your responses make complete sense.

02

The Trauma Brain

How trauma changes the amygdala, hippocampus, and prefrontal cortex.

03

The Four Stress Responses

Fight, flight, freeze, and fawn — recognizing your own patterns.

04

Grounding Techniques

Practical tools for flashbacks, dissociation, and moments of overwhelm.

05

Triggers & Coping Plans

Identifying personal triggers and building a personalized coping strategy.

06

Self-Care & Stabilization

Daily practices that build a stable foundation for ongoing healing.

07

Safety Planning

Building a safety plan and identifying your support system.

08

Evidence-Based Treatment

Exploring professional treatment options and knowing when to seek help.

What This Course IS

- Psychoeducation and skill-building
- A foundation for professional healing work
- A way to build understanding and stability
- Preparing the ground for deeper work

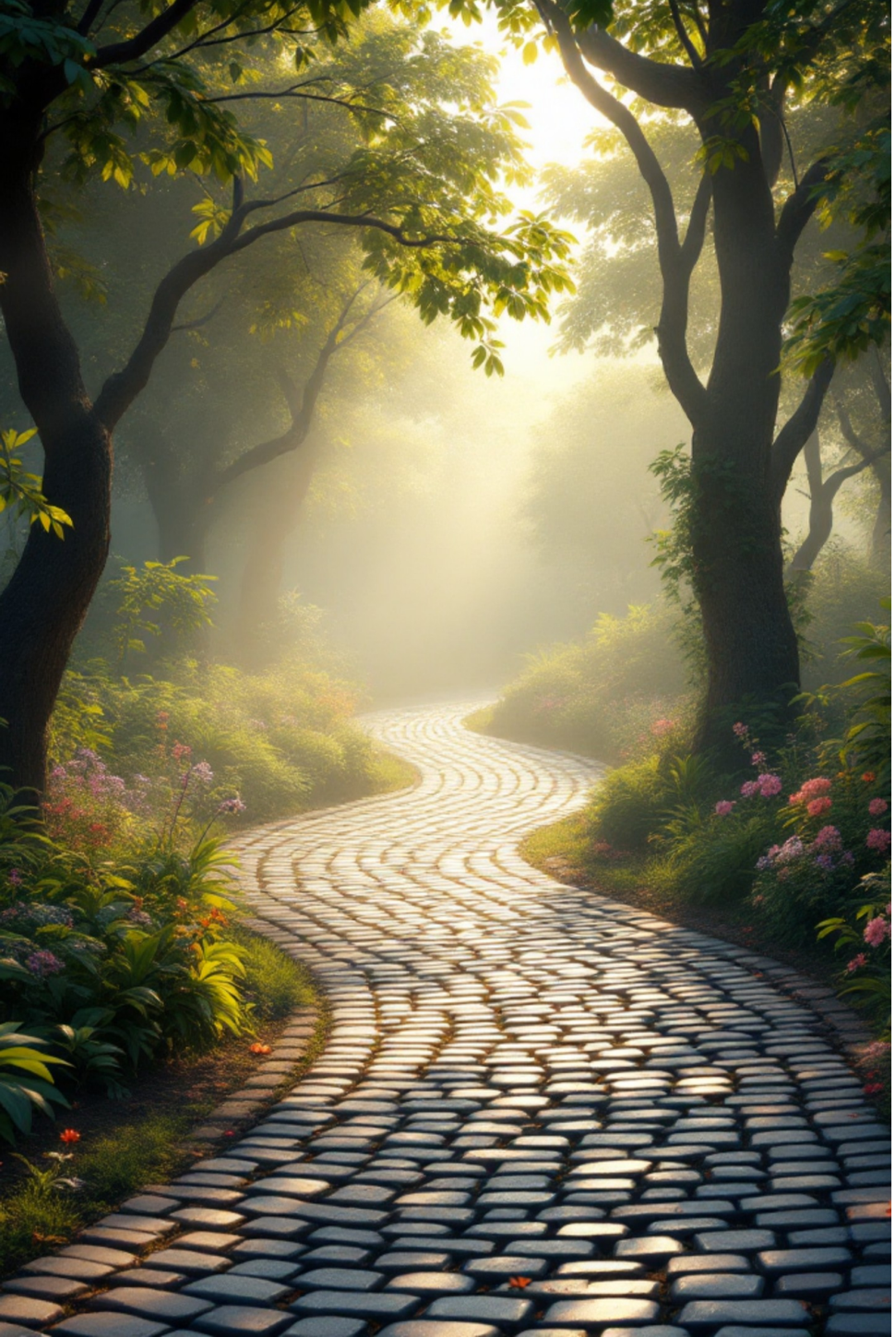
What This Course Is NOT

- Therapy or a replacement for professional care
- A space to process traumatic memories
- A requirement to revisit painful experiences
- A one-size-fits-all solution

This Course Is a Foundation

Think of it as **preparing the ground**. Before a garden can flourish, the soil must be ready. This course builds the understanding, stability, and skills that make professional healing work more effective — without asking you to dig into traumatic memories before you're ready.

> "It will not ask you to process traumatic memories. Instead, it builds the understanding, stability, and skills that make professional healing work more effective."



Course Structure

8

Lessons

Carefully sequenced modules building from foundation to action.

8-10

Hours Total

Flexible, self-paced learning you can fit around your life.

Trauma-Informed

Every lesson is designed with your safety and wellbeing at the center.

Evidence-Based

Grounded in current research on trauma, neuroscience, and recovery.

Go at Your Own Pace

Take breaks whenever you need. Use grounding techniques. Your safety comes first.

A gentle reminder: You are in control of this experience. Pause, breathe, and use grounding techniques whenever you need to. There is no rush. Healing is not linear — and that is okay.